Oath of Dragons

A human in plate armor, painted blue and adorned with scales, delves deeper into the dungeon, searching out dark magical auras. He carries with him a model of a chest, a magical gateway to the stash of other dangerous artifacts he has rescued from evildoers. Suddenly, several of the monsters of the dungeon surround him, and he lets loose a bellowing roar of primeval fury, striking fear into the hearts of his foes.

Flames leap and roar in a small country village, the townspeople unable to stop the blaze. A dwarf charges in, flames rolling off his skin, surrounded by an aura of red energy. He grabs first one, and then another innocent caught in the blaze, dragging them out to safety. He leaves the town that very same night, his name and face forgotten, even by those whose lives he saved.

An elf bows her head in reverence to the great beast in front of her, a brilliant golden dragon, austere and ancient. She removes several items from her pack, all dangerous items stolen for safe keeping. The dragon accepts them all gratefully, gracing his eager pupil with a single scale from his back. A meager token to many, though to the elf it is a badge of the most supreme honor.

The Metallic Dragons are some of the most powerful good-aligned creatures in the world, and also some of the most mysterious. Dragons stay aloof from the mortal affairs, unless there is dire need, but their mystery inspires curiosity in the minds of mortals. Some individuals, those who are inspired by the valor of dragons, pledge their lives to the emulation of the great souls. They strive to uphold the cause of good, with little care for mortal definitions of king and country, or god and faith. They seek dangerous magical items to add to their "hoard," to protect them from those who would use them for evil.

Such a dedication can be formal or informal. Perhaps the paladin met and was inspired by a particular dragon, who then became their probably-reluctant mentor. Or perhaps the paladin found a magical item of great evil, and underwent a quest to gift it to a creature capable of protecting it, and was rewarded for this selfless act. The paladin might even be a morta follower of Bahamut, the Platinum Dragon and God of Metallic Dragons.

No matter the case, the paladin has been infused by draconic magic, and is guided by the example of a certain kind of Metallic Dragon.

Tenets of the Metallic

The tenants of the Metallic Dragons are informal, defined only by the traits of the dragons that paladins seek to emulate. These traits are simple

Strength. Resist the temptations of magical and mundane treasure alike. You are equipped with the power necessary to safeguard such artifacts, but remember that even the highest flying dragons may fall.

Fairness. Reward those who aid you. If another being proves themselves worthy of your thanks, gift them with something to enable their will to do good to expand even further.

Tenets of the Chromatic

If your DM allows, you may play a paladin inspired by the malicious and greedy Chromatic Dragons.

Consider why a Chromatic Dragon would take an apprentice. Perhaps the dragon is lawful, and the mortal did a great service for it. Taking such potential and molding it properly is an admirable goal for any evil dragon. Or maybe the aspiring paladin watched from afar, noting down the ways in which dragons wield their terrible strength. Some might even be mortal servants of Tiamat, the Queen of Chromatic Dragons.

The tenets of Chromatic Dragons are not so much tenets as they are pieces of advice, on how best to dominate the world.

Self. Your power entitles you to the greatest the world has to offer. You come first; your will and desires are more important than all else.

Might. Righteousness flows from power, not some god or ideal. Hone your strength, and sate your own insatiable hunger. The world is a cruel place, and you shall be all the crueler.

Breath. A dragon is not solely defined by her ironlike scales, or her ruinous talons. A dragon loves riddles, twisting words so tightly around the imbecilic peasants that true destruction is mere overkill.

Infamy. While there is much to be said for subtlety, there is far more to say for the power of fear. As a countryside quivers in terror at the shadow of leathery wings, so too should they cower at your dreadful presence.

Breath. Make every exhalation bring with it power and righteousness. Whether by speaking out against darkness, or bringing light to the hopeless, make your breath a positive tempest of good for the world.

Memory. Ageless and unending, dragons seek not fame nor fortune for their good deeds. So make the memory of you faint in the minds of those you aid, and keep your own memories of such joyous acts fresh and pure.

Oath Spells

Paladin Level	Spells
3rd	*detect magic, identify*
5th	*alter self, arcane lock*
9th	*fly, glyph of warding*
13th	*Leomund's secret chest, Mordenkainen's private sanctum*
17th	*seeming, teleportation circle*

Draconic Inspiration

When you take this oath at 3rd level, you choose one Draconic Inspiration from the list below. This inspiration comes from the type of dragon that you seek to emulate. You gain access to abilities that utilize the damage type associated with this type of dragon as you level, and a dragon of this race is generally your mentor, if you had one.

While most who take the Oath of Dragons are good-aligned crusaders, seeking to protect the world from evil, there are those who have darker aims. Some envy the sheer wealth and power of the dragons, and seek ou their strength for personal gain. The Chromatic Draconic Inspirations are listed after their Metallic counterparts.

Draconic Inspiration Types

Dragon	Damage Type
Brass, **Gold**, ***Red***	Fire
Bronze, ***Blue***	Lightning
Copper, ***Black***	Acid
Silver, ***White***	Cold
Green	Poison

Channel Divinity

When you take this oath at 3rd level, you gain the following two Channel Divinity options.

Dragon's Breath. As an action, you can exhale destructive energy. Your Draconic Inspiration determines the damage type and shape of this breath weapon (as shown in the Dragonborn racial table).

When you use your breath weapon, each creature in the area of the exhalation must make a saving throw, the type of which is determined by your Draconic Inspiration. The DC for this saving throw is equal to your paladin spellcasting DC. A creature takes damage equal to your paladin level + 2d10 on a failed save, and half as much damage on a successful one.

If you are a dragonborn, you retain the normal use of your racial breath weapon in addition to this Channel Divinity feature. You must wait one turn after using either this Channel Divinity or your racial breath weapon in order to use the other, as you must catch your breath

Dragon's Roar. As an action, you roar with the ferocity and energy of a dragon, using your Channel Divinity. Each hostile creature within 30 ft of you must make a Wisdom saving throw. If the creature fails its saving throw, it is frightened by you for 1 minute. If the creature was concentrating on a spell and fails the Wisdom save, they must make a DC 10 concentration check.

Draconic Strike

When you take this oath at 3rd level, your Divine Smite changes to reflect your draconic power. Your Divine Smite feature now deals its damage as the type specified by your Draconic Inspiration. This damage ignores resistances, but an immune creature still takes no damage from this ability.

At 11th level, your Improved Divine Strike feature is likewise changed. All of your attacks now deal an extra 1d8 damage of the type associated with your Draconic Inspiration.

Draconian Knowledge

At 7th level, you learn to identify magic and cursed items more easily. You may choose to attempt to detect curses on a magic item when you cast *identify* on it by making a Charisma ability check with a DC determined by your DM. On a success, you know only that the item is cursed, not what curse it might bear. You also gain the ability to cast *detect magic* and *identify* as rituals, even if you do not know the spells.

Additionally, you learn Draconic if you do not already know it. You have advantage on any rolls involving talking to or interacting with dragons or their followers. The followers of dragons might mistake you for one of their peers, while most dragons will identify you as one trained and mentored by one of their kind.

Dragon Soul

Beginning at 15th level, you start to take on some of the traits of metallic dragons. You can infuse your very being with draconic magic, to protect either yourself or others, as the ideals of the metallic begin to sink into your soul.

Resilient Scales. You gain resistance to the damage type associated with your Draconic Inspiration. As a reaction, you may either gain immunity to this damage type, or resistance to damage from nonmagical weapons. This lasts for one minute, and you may use this feature once pe long rest. You may not use this feature while transformed by your Platinum God feature.

Booming Voice. You may use the thundering voice of dragons to focus attention on yourself, and save your allies. Any hostile creature within 5 feet of you has disadvantage on attacks against any other target, save for another character with this ability. Using this ability requires concentration (as if casting a concentration spell), and it cannot be used when silenced or mute. A creature is immune to this if it can't hear you, or is immune to being frightened.

Metallic Hoard

At 15th level, you may create your own personal dragon's hoard for storing any magic items you run across during your travels. When you cast *Mordenkainen's private sanctum*, you may make the effects of the spell permanent after only three months of daily casting, rather than a full year. You may do the same with the spell *teleportation circle*, once you learn it.

Furthermore, when you cast *Leomund's secret chest*, you may choose to store your chest in your hoard, rather than in the Ethereal Plane. If you do so, there is no cumulative chance that the spell's effect ends after a certain time period, but a creature within your hoard may access the chest normally, unless you otherwise lock it.

You may only have one hoard at a time. If you attempt to create a new hoard using *Mordenkainen's private sanctum*, the magic surrounding the old hoard fades within a day. If the chest from *Leomund's secret chest* is still within the old hoard's location, the spell's effects end, and you must travel to the location itself to retrieve the chest.

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Platinum God

At 20th level, you can assume the form of a lesser dragon. You can either choose to transform into a humanoid half-dragon form with great wings (your clothing and armor must be made to accommodate this), or you may choose to transform yourself and everything you carry fully into a lesser dragon. You may use this feature once per long rest. For 1 minute, you gain the following benefits:

- Wings sprout from your back and grant you a flying speed of 60 feet.
- You gain immunity to the damage type associated with your Draconic Inspiration and resistance to nonmagical weapons. You may not gain resistance to nonmagical weapon damage from using your Metallic Hoard feature during this period.
- You gain two additional uses of your Channel Divinity feature. These additional uses must be used on the options granted to you by the paladin class, and are lost when you transform back.

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